

Marking Rubric: Case Analysis and Design Proposal Report (COSC2407)

Assessment Case Analysis and Design Proposal Report
Course COSC2407 Digital Systems Design
Weighting 40% of the final course grade
Total marks 100
Instrument Analytic rubric, five criteria
Marker Course tutor, moderated by the course coordinator

1. How to read this rubric

The five criteria below sum to 100 marks, which is the whole of the assessment. Each criterion states its weight and describes the standard that separates a pass from a distinction. A criterion marked at the pass standard earns half of the weighted marks for that criterion; a criterion marked at the distinction standard earns most of them. The mark for the assessment is the sum of the weighted marks awarded.

The rubric describes what is rewarded. It does not describe how to produce any part of the report, and nothing in it authorises work that the assessment AI Usage Policy prohibits.

2. Criteria, weights, and pass/distinction standards

Criterion 1 -- Problem framing (20 marks)

Pass standard	Distinction standard
States the purpose of the service and names at least one finding from the case pack.	States the problem as a claim the evidence can test, and reads the evidence against it without overclaiming what the case pack can support.
Relies on assertion where evidence exists.	
Treats the case pack as background.	Distinguishes evidence from interpretation.

Criterion 2 -- Design rationale, Part B (25 marks)

Pass standard	Distinction standard
Proposes a response and describes it.	Justifies each design decision against named evidence and against the course literature, and names at least one decision it chose not to make, with the reason.
Gives reasons, but the reasons restate the proposal rather than supporting it.	
Some decisions are unexplained.	

Criterion 3 -- Stakeholder and needs analysis (20 marks)

Pass standard	Distinction standard
Identifies the main stakeholder groups and lists what each needs.	Derives each need from a specific piece of evidence or an explicit assumption, and shows where two groups' needs conflict and how the conflict is handled in the proposal.
Needs are plausible but not traced to anything in the case pack.	

Criterion 4 -- Risks, ethics, and conclusion (25 marks)

Pass standard	Distinction standard
Identifies at least three risks or ethical considerations and gives a conclusion.	Ties each risk to its source, states the condition under which it would become real, and states what would change the advice
Risks are generic and could apply to any	

service.

given in the conclusion.

Criterion 5 -- Communication, referencing, and assessment compliance (10 marks)

Pass standard

Distinction standard

Writing is understandable and the report has a reference list. Referencing is largely consistent. The body is within the word count stated in the brief.

Writing is precise and economical; every source is acknowledged where it is used, including any permitted use of generative AI. The body is within 1,620 to 1,980 words and the declared count matches the submitted document.

3. Weight summary

Criterion	Weight
1. Problem framing	20
2. Design rationale (Part B)	25
3. Stakeholder and needs analysis	20
4. Risks, ethics, and conclusion	25
5. Communication, referencing, and assessment compliance	10
Total	100

The five weights sum to 100. The word-count requirement stated in the assessment brief is enforced under criterion 5: a body outside 1,620 to 1,980 words is penalised there and nowhere else.

4. Applying the rubric

- Each criterion is marked against the standards above; a marker may not invent a standard that this rubric does not describe.
- A criterion at the pass standard earns half of its weighted marks. A criterion at the distinction standard earns 80% or more of its weighted marks.
- The marks are summed and reported out of 100. No criterion is weighted twice.
- A report that breaches the assessment AI Usage Policy is referred to the academic integrity process; it is not marked against this rubric and no criterion can offset the breach.
- Moderation is performed by the course coordinator on a sample of at least 20% of submissions before marks are released.